Launching Japanese and Korean Cosmetics in India: Comprehensive Guide

Executive Summary

Japanese (J-beauty) and Korean (K-beauty) cosmetics are booming in India. Studies forecast K-beauty sales rising from about **$400M (2024)** to **$1.5B by 2030** (CAGR ~26%) [1], outpacing the broader cosmetics market (12%) [1]. J-beauty is also growing (predicted ~$2.6B→$3.7B by 2030 [2]) as Indian consumers seek "natural" skincare with premium ingredients [2] [3]. However, many niche Asian products (e.g. high-SPF Japanese sunscreens, Korean serums/essences, sheet masks, night creams) remain hard to find on Indian e-tailers, creating an opportunity. This guide analyzes demand/trends, identifies product gaps, recommends top SKUs/brands, and lays out an actionable roadmap covering suppliers, import compliance, operations, pricing, and marketing strategy (Instagram-first launch to a full e-commerce site). We include detailed tables (supplier comparisons, SKU list, sample P&Ls, timeline) and a mermaid customer-funnel to follow step-by-step.

1. Market Demand & Gaps

India's beauty market is expanding rapidly, driven by youth demographics and K-pop/Hallyu influence. K-beauty products (e.g. snail-mucin essences, sheet masks, cushion foundations) appeal to "glass skin" and multitasking routines [4] [5]. One report predicts **K-beauty users growing from ~12M to 27M by 2030** [6]. J-beauty (clean formulas, high SPF sunscreens, antioxidants) is on the rise too; analysts note Indians buying more "sunscreens, serums, cleansing oils, lip care" [3]. In short, consumers want efficacy and "minimal" routines – e.g. high-quality moisturizers, serums, essences, and unique items like Korea's vitamin C and propolis serums or Japan's hydrogel masks.

Yet product gaps remain. Many Korean brands (Beauty of Joseon, Skin1004, Dr. Jart+, Klairs, etc.) and Japanese staples (Hada Labo serums, SK-II essences, Anessa sunscreens, DHC oil cleansers) are scarcely stocked on Indian sites. Social listening (forums, Instagram) shows Indians often import via personal shoppers or use limited local offerings. Established e-tailers (Nykaa, Amazon) carry basic K-beauty, but lack depth in J-beauty and niche K-items [7] [8]. **Key product gaps** include: advanced serums (niacinamide, centella, snail), premium sheet/peel masks, ultra-light sunscreens (SPF50+), and multi-use skincare (BB cushions, lip tints). Top categories to source (hard-to-find in India) are:

- **Sun protection** (Japanese high-SPF sunscreens like Shiseido's Anessa, Biore UV Aqua Rich) [3].
- **Serums & essences** (Korea's COSRX Snail 96%, Beauty of Joseon Propolis/Niacinamide [4]; Japan's SK-II Facial Treatment Essence).
- **Cleansers/oils** (Japanese DHC Deep Cleansing Oil; Korea's Heimish All-Clean balm).
- **Sheet masks/ampoules** (Skin1004 Centella Ampoule Mask [9]; Nature Republic/Royal Jelly masks).
- **Lip and eye care** (Laneige Lip Sleeping Mask [10]; Etude House lip tints; Kanebo lip balm).

In summary, demand is high for quality J/K beauty, but existing Indian channels cover only mainstream items. The **opportunity** is to import and market premium, underrepresented SKUs that Indian consumers crave.

2. Prioritized Products (SKUs)

We recommend stocking 20–30 high-demand SKUs (Table 1). Prioritize skin-care and make-up categories where Asia excels: serums, essences, sheet masks, sunscreens, BB cushions, and specialized cleansers. Table 1 lists candidate items (brand, product name, category) focusing on *hard-to-find* jewels (many are not carried by Nykaa/Flipkart). For example, COSRX Snail 96 Mucin Essence, Beauty of Joseon Ginseng Serum, and Shiseido Anessa Sunscreen are flagship products [4] [3]. (Sources: market analyses [2] [3], trend articles [4], and Indian beauty forums.)

Table 1: Sample SKUs to Source (by category). (*Hard-to-find or premium Asian brands.*)

Category	Brand (Origin)	Example Product	Notes
Sun protection	Anessa (Japan)	Perfect UV Sunscreen Skincare Milk	Japan's #1 sunscreen, SPF50+
	Biore (Japan)	UV Aqua Rich Watery Gel SPF50	Lightweight, cult favorite
	Skin Aqua (Japan)	Super Moisture Gel SPF50	Affordable J-beauty choice
Essences/ Serums	SK-II (Japan)	Facial Treatment Essence (Pitera)	High-end skin treatment
	COSRX (Korea)	Snail 96 Mucin Essence	Hydration, healing [4]
	Beauty of Joseon (KR)	Ginseng Essence Water	Korean herbal anti-aging [4]
	Elizavecca (KR)	Galactomyces Essence	Ferment-goodness serum
Moisturizers	Hada Labo (Japan)	Gokujyun Hyaluronic Cream	Ultra-hydrating moisturiser
	Laneige (KR)	Cream Skin Refiner	Pre-moistened toner-rich spray
	Sulwhasoo (KR)	Concentrated Ginseng Cream (anti-aging)	Luxury brand, popular among Asians
Cleansers/ Oils	DHC (Japan)	Deep Cleansing Oil (Camellia oil)	#1 Japanese oil cleanser
	Perfect Whip (Japan)	Senka Perfect Whip Foam	Top-rated foam cleanser

Category	Brand (Origin)	Example Product	Notes
	Banila Co (KR)	Clean It Zero Cleansing Balm (Original)	Cult Korean makeup remover
Masks	Mediheal (KR)	NMF Aquaring Hydrogel Mask	Intensive sheet mask for hydration
	Dr. Jart (KR)	Dermask Water Jet Vital Hydra	Specialized sheet mask brand
	innisfree (KR)	Green Tea Serum or Mask	Natural ingredients, Korean brand
Makeup	Canmake (Japan)	Cream Cheek (blush stick)	Popular Japanese blush tint
	Pony Effect (KR)	Eyeshadow Palette (neutral tones)	Influencer's own make-up line
	Etude House (KR)	Dear Darling Tint (lip stain)	Trending Korean lip tint
Haircare/Body	Shiseido Fino (Japan)	Premium Touch Hair Mask/Oil	Top Japanese hair treatment (lipid)
	Tsubaki (Japan)	Premium Repair Shampoo	Camellia oil haircare products
	&honey (Japan)	Deep Moist Hair Oil	Hair oil brand popular in Asia

Note: Product selection should be refined via direct market research (surveys, social media queries) and competitor scans (local e-tailers). Sources: industry forecasts [2] [1] and trend publications [4].

3. Sourcing Channels & Suppliers

To procure these products, use **multiple channels**:

- **Authorized Distributors / Brand Direct:** Some brands have official import channels in India (e.g. Shiseido/Anessa, Amorepacific/Laneige) [11]. Contact corporate offices or local distributors (e.g. UG of Japan, or K-beauty councils) for direct accounts.
- **Regional Wholesalers:** B2B platforms offer bulk authentic stock. For Korea: **UMMA** (Seoul-based, 15,000+ K-beauty SKUs) [12] and **Q-Depot** (Hong Kong; ~400 Korean + 100 Japanese brands) [13]. For Japan: **Q-Depot** (also 100+ Japanese brands, e.g. Shiseido, Hada Labo, SK-II) [8] and **J-Beauty Wholesale** (HK/US warehouse, stocks Fino, &honey haircare, etc.) [14]. These sites ship worldwide with MOQs (often $200–$500).
- **Online B2B Marketplaces:** Alibaba, Global Sources – but vet suppliers carefully to avoid counterfeits. (Always require COA/COO certificates.)
- **Trade Shows & Missions:** Participate or visit trade fairs like **BeautySum India/Korea** [15], Cosmoprof Asia, or KOTRA-sponsored expos. These connect buyers to manufacturers. Government export councils (CEPA India, KOTRA) can arrange meetings with Korean/Japanese suppliers.

- **Agents/Importers:** Hire import agents or consultants who handle compliance (e.g. Regacats Solutions [16]) and have existing supplier networks. Some Indian boutique importers (e.g. Dre, Aspee Skincare) can be partners.

Table 2: Supplier Comparison (illustrative)

Supplier / Source	Region	Brands / Products	MOQ / Terms	Pros	Cons
Q-Depot	HK (ships globally)	100+ J-beauty & 400+ K-beauty brands [13]	~$300 min	Huge selection; tracked logistics; COA available [13]	Foreign shipping lead-time; currency risk
UMMA	Korea (Seoul HQ)	180+ K-brands; 15,000+ SKUs [12]	None (per item)	Easy online ordering; fast (48h) bulk shipping [17]	High volume focus; no J-beauty
JBeautyWholesale	HK/US	Japanese hair & skin (Fino, &honey, etc.) [14]	Unit price ~$5-10	Wholesale pricing; ships worldwide	Non-Indian return policy; fixed markup
Harumio / Dropship	Korea (online)	Wide K-beauty catalog (COSRX, Missha, etc.)	No MOQ (dropship)	7-day FedEx/ DHL delivery [18] ; white-label options	Higher per-unit cost; reliant on third-party fulfilment [18]
Official Importers	India	Shiseido, SK-II, Amorepacific, etc.	Purchase from local principal	Official channels, marketing support	Limited to big brands; may have territorial exclusivity
Trade Agents	India/ KR/JP	N/A (broker/ import)	Commission/ fee	Handles compliance, documentation	Adds cost; variable reliability

Note: Always verify supplier authenticity (request certificates of origin, manufacturing, ingredient lists) before ordering. Evaluate pros/cons such as MOQ vs. unit price, shipping time, and payment terms.

4. Import Regulations & Compliance

Imports must follow India's **Drugs & Cosmetics Act (1940)** and related rules. Key requirements are:

- **CDSCO Registration:** Every new imported cosmetic product needs approval (Form 42/COS-2) via the CDSCO's SUGAM portal [19] [16]. Applications (by an Indian entity or appointed agent [20]) require: Free Sale Certificate (FSC) from the manufacturer's country (apostilled), a GMP certificate, ingredient list/MSDS, and labeling draft [21] [19]. This process takes **~2–3 months** [22]. Without CDSCO registration, customs will not clear the products [16].

- **Import License (IEC):** The Indian importer must have an Importer-Exporter Code (IEC) from DGFT [23]. Also obtain a GSTIN (Goods & Services Tax ID) for sales (cosmetics attract 28% GST post-2025 reforms [24]; perfumes 28% [25]). Duty rates vary by HS code (skincare: 3304; haircare: 3305; perfumes: 3303 [26]). Including freight, landed cost can be 40–65% above product cost [26]. Factor this into pricing.

- **Labeling:** Must comply with Cosmetics Rules 2020. Labels must be in English (or Hindi) and include: product name, batch/lot, Mfg/exp dates, net contents, manufacturer name/address (and **importer's name/address**) [27] [28], country of origin [29]. The importer's local contact and CDSCO registration number must be on the label [28]. Example checklist (from Regacats): product name, ingredient list, Mfg/expiry dates, importer name, "Imported by" statement [30] [27]. Inadequate labeling is a common cause of customs rejections [31].

- **BIS Standards:** Many cosmetics ingredients are covered by Indian standards (e.g. IS 4707 for raw materials, IS 15153 for facepacks) [32]. Ensure formulations avoid banned/prescribed substances (check Drugs Rules Schedules). If needed, obtain Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS) certification for ingredients (but generally optional for finished cosmetics).

- **Documentation:** Prepare a Commercial Invoice, Packing List, FSC, Certificate of Origin, Bill of Lading/Airway Bill, and any third-party quality certificates. Use an Authorized Dealer Bank for forex and customs clearance. Ensure timely submission to customs to avoid delays [33] [34].

Failure to meet these can cause seizures or fines. It's wise to consult a regulatory expert or firm for the CDSCO process [16] [19].

5. Logistics & Inventory Strategy

Decide between **dropshipping** versus **bulk import** (or a hybrid) depending on capital and risk tolerance.

- **Dropshipping:** Companies like Harumio (Korea) and ZQ Dropshipping offer no-minimum, worldwide fulfillment. Harumio boasts *"7-day world delivery via FedEx/DHL"* [18], making it quick for small batches. ZQ highlights product trend sourcing and end-to-end order handling (sourcing, QC, customs, shipping) [5]. Dropship pros: no upfront inventory, easy to test products. Cons: higher per-unit cost, longer shipping than local stock, less brand control.

- **Bulk Import:** For better margins, import in containers or LCL (less-than-container) by air/sea. As an estimate: **air freight (2–8 days)** or **sea freight (~15–50 days)** from Korea [35] (Japan similar). Include lead-time for manufacturing (1–4 weeks). Upon arrival, use a 3PL/warehousing partner (e.g. Delhivery, Shiprocket) for fulfillment. Advantages: lower cost/unit, local stock for fast delivery, branding freedom. Downsides: higher capital, warehousing expense, inventory risk.

- **Inventory:** Start lean: order small initial batches of top SKUs (10–50 units each) to validate demand. Use an Indian warehouse near metro clusters (Mumbai/Delhi) for quick reach. Maintain safety stock for bestsellers. Implement inventory software or simple spreadsheets to reorder as needed.

- **Logistics Costs:** Remember import duties and GST (~40–65% landing markup [26]). Domestic shipping (courier costs, ~₹150–300 in India) should be factored into pricing or free-shipping thresholds.

In summary, a recommended approach: use dropshipping for initial Instagram sales (no capital outlay) and gather customer feedback. Simultaneously work on bulk import for core SKUs, so that once demand is proven, larger, cost-effective orders can be shipped and stocked.

6. Pricing, Margins & Sample P&Ls

Set retail prices to cover costs (import+Cogs), taxes, marketing, and profit. Cosmetics often allow **40–60% gross margins** at retail. Consider two scenarios:

- **Instagram Launch (Dropship)**: Higher unit costs (since volume is low). E.g., a Korean serum might land at ₹1,200 (dropship, incl. freight/duty) and sell at ₹2,500 on Instagram – gross margin ~52%. After ads/influencer fees (~10–15%), net margin ~30–35%.
- **Website Scale (Bulk)**: Lower landed cost per unit (sea freight). The same serum might cost ₹1,000 landed for bulk orders, sell at ₹2,500 – gross margin ~60%. With larger volume, margin per unit is healthier despite marketing expenses.

Table 3: Sample Unit Economics (per product)

Scenario	Landed Cost (₹)	Selling Price (₹)	Gross Margin (%)
Dropship (small)	1,200	2,500	52%
Bulk Import (avg)	1,000	2,500	60%

(Assumes typical import duty/GST; actual costs vary by product.)

For a simple 3-month P&L model, factor: COGS, import taxes, shipping (in/out), marketing spend (ads/influencers), platform fees (Instagram ads/Payment gateway ~2–3%), and overhead (warehousing, packaging). As an example: with ₹5L monthly sales, COGS 40%, ad spend 15%, GST 28% (added to price, remitted), net profit 10–15%. These are illustrative; detailed financial planning should be done with actual quotes and volume estimates.

7. Instagram Marketing Strategy

Start by **launching an Instagram Business profile** focused on J/K beauty. Tactics include:

- **Content Calendar:** Post 3–5 times/week. Mix formats: product photos, tutorials (e.g. “7-step Korean cleansing”), before-after demos, and user-generated content (UGC). Use Reels frequently (high engagement) – e.g. quick skincare tips or “First Impression” videos with products [5]. Sample schedule (see Table 4): product highlights on Mon/Wed, a Reel on Fri (skincare tip or fun K-beauty fact), weekend interactive stories (polls/Q&A). Use consistent branding (aesthetic, color scheme) to build identity.

- **Hashtags & Tags:** Use relevant hashtags (#KBeauty, #JBeauty, #AsianSkincare, #GlowingSkin) plus Indian tags (#BeautyIndia) to reach audiences. Tag products once IG Shopping is enabled.

- **Influencer/KOL Outreach:** Identify 10–20 micro-influencers (10K–100K followers) in India who love K/J beauty (e.g. #BeautyBlogger, #SkincareIndia). Send them PR packages or affiliate offers. Craft a friendly DM script: e.g. “Hi [Name], we admire your content on skincare. We’d love to send you our Korean serum to try – would you be interested?” Include product benefits. Track ROI on their promo codes. Consider 1-2 macro influencers (100K+) for broader reach once budget allows.

- **Paid Ads:** Run Instagram/Facebook ads targeting demographics (18–35 F, metro cities) and interests (K-beauty, J-beauty, skincare). Use eye-catching video ads (Reels-sized) showcasing product before/after. Budget modestly at start (₹20K–₹50K/month) to drive profile visits and website clicks. A/B test ad creatives and optimize for “Add to Cart”.

- **UGC & Engagement:** Encourage customers to share selfies using a campaign (e.g. “#MyKBeautyRoutine”) and repost on your page (with permission). Respond to comments/DMs promptly to build community. Use Instagram Live or Stories for Q&A sessions or unboxing demos.

- **Shopping Tags:** Once you have a website/e-commerce ready, enable Instagram Shopping. Tag products in posts/Reels so users can tap and shop seamlessly.

Overall, focus on educational and aspirational content (demonstrating product efficacy) rather than pure advertising. Track Instagram metrics (followers, engagement, click-throughs) weekly.

8. Customer Acquisition Funnel (Mermaid)

Below is a high-level funnel illustrating how an Instagram-first strategy converts to sales and retention:

```
flowchart LR
    A[Instagram Content & Ads] --> B[Followers & Website Visitors]
    B --> C[Engagement (Likes, Comments, DMs)]
    C --> D[Product Discovery (IG Shop / Website)]
    D --> E[Purchase]
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    E --> F[Order Fulfillment & Thank You]
    F --> G[Retention (Email/WhatsApp follow-up, Reviews)]
```

- **Awareness (A→B):** Use Reels, influencer shoutouts, and ads to drive users to your IG page or landing page.
- **Interest & Engagement (B→C):** Nurture leads via interactive posts (polls, tutorials) and timely responses. Build Instagram DM relationships for personal selling (customers in India often DM/WhatsApp to order).
- **Conversion (C→D→E):** Guide users to a shop link or accept orders via Instagram Direct / WhatsApp. Simplify checkout (COD, UPI, wallets).
- **Retention (F→G):** After purchase, send order confirmations and product tips via email/WhatsApp. Implement a simple loyalty scheme (points or discounts on repeat orders) and request reviews/testimonials for social proof.

9. Customer Retention & Support

- **Loyalty Program:** Offer repeat customers discounts or a small “K-beauty Club” points system (e.g. ₹1=1 point). Reward referrals with coupon codes.
- **Email/WhatsApp Marketing:** Collect customer emails/phones (opt-in during checkout) and send monthly newsletters (new arrivals, K-beauty tips). Use WhatsApp Business for order updates and customer service (over 400M Indians use WhatsApp).
- **Reviews & Feedback:** Encourage product reviews on your site and on Instagram. Feature user reviews in posts/stories for social proof.
- **Easy Returns:** Even though cosmetics have hygiene constraints, offer hassle-free returns for defective or damaged items (e.g. full refund or replacement). A clear returns policy builds trust.
- **Customer Support:** Provide quick support via WhatsApp or email. Use FAQ pages or chatbots for common queries (shipping time, usage). Good post-sales service increases retention.

10. E-commerce Website Plan

After building an Instagram following, transition to a dedicated online store:

- **Platform:** Consider Shopify (easy, secure) or WooCommerce (flexible). Shopify India supports UPI, cards, wallets, and can integrate Instagram Shopping.
- **Payments:** Integrate Indian-friendly gateways (Razorpay, Stripe India, Paytm, PayPal) and popular local methods (UPI, netbanking) [23] . Ensure PCI compliance.
- **SEO & Content:** Optimize site for search (keywords like “Korean serum India”, “Japanese sunscreen”). Maintain a blog (skincare tips, ingredient explainers) to drive organic traffic. Use Google Analytics and Facebook Pixel to track visitors and ad ROI.
- **UI/UX:** Design a clean site with clear product categories, filters (by concern, brand), and high-res photos. Include trust signals (secure checkout, genuine product guarantee). Implement CRO best-practices: prominent “Add to Cart” buttons, customer testimonials, and exit-intent popups with discount offers.
- **Logistics Integration:** Link with a fulfillment app or 3PL to auto-generate shipping labels. For example, use Shiprocket/Delhivery plugins to speed order processing.

- **Analytics:** Set up Google Analytics 4 for conversions, and regularly review metrics (conversion rate, bounce rate, average order value). Tweak site based on data (e.g., if many abandon carts, simplify checkout or offer discounts).

11. Legal, Banking & Risk Management

- **Business Setup:** Incorporate as a Private Limited Company or LLP (Private Ltd is preferred for ease of opening bank accounts and importing). Register for GST (18–28% on cosmetics) and IEC (DGFT) [23]. Maintain full invoicing and compliance.
- **Banking/Forex:** Use an authorized dealer bank (ICICI, HDFC, SBI, etc.) that handles import transactions and Forex. Open a current account for FX receipts/payments. Consider keeping a multi-currency account to hedge payments (INR vs KRW/JPY/USD). Use forward contracts if large currency exposure.
- **Legal:** Ensure trademarks (for your brand) and handle intellectual property (avoid gray-market imports of trademarked products without permission). Comply with the Plastic Waste Management Rules (EPR for cosmetics packaging – recycle scheme). If claiming "organic" or "certified", have certificates (though Indians trust "Japanese/Korean brand" more than local organics).
- **Quality & Safety:** Order products from reputable sources only. Perform random lab tests for heavy metals/pesticides if sourcing lesser-known brands. Prepare to recall if any safety issue arises (this is rare for imported cosmetics but plan capital reserve).
- **Risk Mitigation:** The main risks are regulatory delays (factor 2–3 months for CDSCO [22]), currency fluctuation, and competition. Mitigate by starting with smaller batches, locking in costs, and keeping updated on India's banned cosmetic substances list.

12. Launch Timeline (First 12 Weeks)

Week	Key Activities
1	**Market Scan & Setup:** Finalize product list; register company (Private Ltd), GST, IEC. Set up Instagram page and brand identity. Begin discussions with suppliers (collect catalogs, pricing).
2	**Regulatory & Banking:** Engage CDSCO consultant; prepare CDSCO applications (FSC, formulas). Open bank account with import facility; obtain Forex guidelines.
3	**Supplier Outreach:** Order samples from 5–10 vendors (both dropship and bulk). Negotiate MOQs/ pricing. Register seller accounts on UMMA/Q-Depot to compare prices.
4	**Import Prep:** Submit CDSCO applications online. Vet samples; select top 5 SKUs. Finalize branding (logo, website domain). Outline Instagram content calendar (see Table 4).
5	**Marketing Setup:** Begin posting teasers on IG (brand story, coming soon). Reach out to 10 micro-influencers with PR samples. Plan first paid ad campaigns.
6	**Order Placement:** Place first bulk order (air freight) for 2–3 best-selling SKUs; also test-drop 5 SKUs via dropship for IG store.
7	**Operations:** Receive first dropship inventory (if any). Audit packaging, label compliance (make sure all imported labels include required info [36]). Stock in local warehouse/fulfillment centre.

Week	Key Activities
8	**Soft Launch:** Activate Instagram Shopping (if available). Start small Instagram ad campaign; introduce products one-by-one with posts/Reels. Begin collecting pre-orders (COD/UPI payments) via IG/WhatsApp.
9	**Fulfillment & Feedback:** Ship initial orders; gather feedback. Refine customer messages (order confirmation texts). Post UGC or testimonials from early buyers.
10	**Scale Marketing:** Increase ad budget; add a mid-tier influencer partnership. Launch first promotions (e.g. bundle discount). Prepare for website development (choose platform).
11	**Website Go-Live:** Launch e-commerce site with shopping cart. Enable UPI, card payments. Redirect Instagram "Shop Now" links to website. Set up email marketing (Mailchimp) and analytics.
12	**Review & Optimize:** Analyze sales data (best-sellers, conversion rates). Plan next bulk orders for popular SKUs. Implement retention tactics (loyalty points, repeat buyer discounts). Adjust strategy for Q2.

Table 4: Sample Instagram Content Calendar (4-week excerpt)

Week	Monday (Post)	Wednesday (Post)	Friday (Reel)	Sunday (Stories)
1	Product Spotlight: *[Product A]* (benefits, use)	Behind-the-scenes (unboxing SK)	Reel: "How to use *Product A*"	Poll/Q&A: "Which K-beauty step is your fav?"
2	Tutorial: morning skincare routine (with our items)	UGC repost: customer testimonial	Reel: Korean sunscreen vs. others	Quiz: "Guess this Korean ingredient"
3	Influencer Feature: [Name] using our serum	Product Highlight: *[Product B]*	Reel: Lip care tips (demonstrate lip tint)	Live: quick skincare Q&A
4	Brand Story: Why we love J/K beauty	Sale announcement (limited bundle offer)	Reel: "5 Steps to glass skin"	Countdown sticker to bundle launch

(*Adjust topics each week; use relevant hashtags and tag any influencers/products.*)

Sources

- Market and trend data: Industry analyses and news [1] [2] [3].
- Product trends: K-beauty editorial lists [4] [9].
- Regulatory details: CDSCO/regulatory consultants [19] [16] [27].
- Sourcing channels: B2B platforms (UMMA [12], Q-depot [8], J-Beauty Wholesale [14]).
- Logistics: Shipping and dropship info [18] [35].
- GST & Taxes: Official GST sources [24].

This roadmap outlines every step from product selection to post-launch growth. By following it, an entrepreneur can systematically tap into India's growing appetite for Japanese and Korean cosmetics.

Open Questions / Considerations: Actual launch plans should adapt to evolving regulations and market feedback. Key uncertainties include precise demand elasticity for each SKU and potential new import restrictions. Keep monitoring the Cosmetics Rules (new amendments) and be prepared to iterate on supplier/marketing choices based on real sales data.

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